

TULIPS

Overview

Tulips Café is a simulation game that merges elements of time management, resource management, and dual perspective game play.

The game features two primary playable characters: Anne, the café owner who handles resources and strategy,

Jessica, the waitress who manages orders, customer interactions, and dish preparations. The player switches between both characters to optimize the café's operations while interacting with a diverse set of customer witches.

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Gameplay & Mechanics

Switching Perspectives

The player can switch between Anne and Jessica. Each character has distinct responsibilities and tasks:



Anne: Manages resources, unlock new dishes and researches recipes.

Jessica: Fulfill orders, serves dishes and interacts with customers.



The switch consumes Action Points(AP),which are limited each day. This mechanic forces players to prioritize tasks and make strategic decisions on when to switch between the characters.

Resource Management

Essence

A magical resource used to unlock new recipes and upgrade the café's offerings.



Gold

A more mundane resource used for daily purchases like Essence and upgrades.



Reputation

Gained by serving all the delivery orders and witches within today.



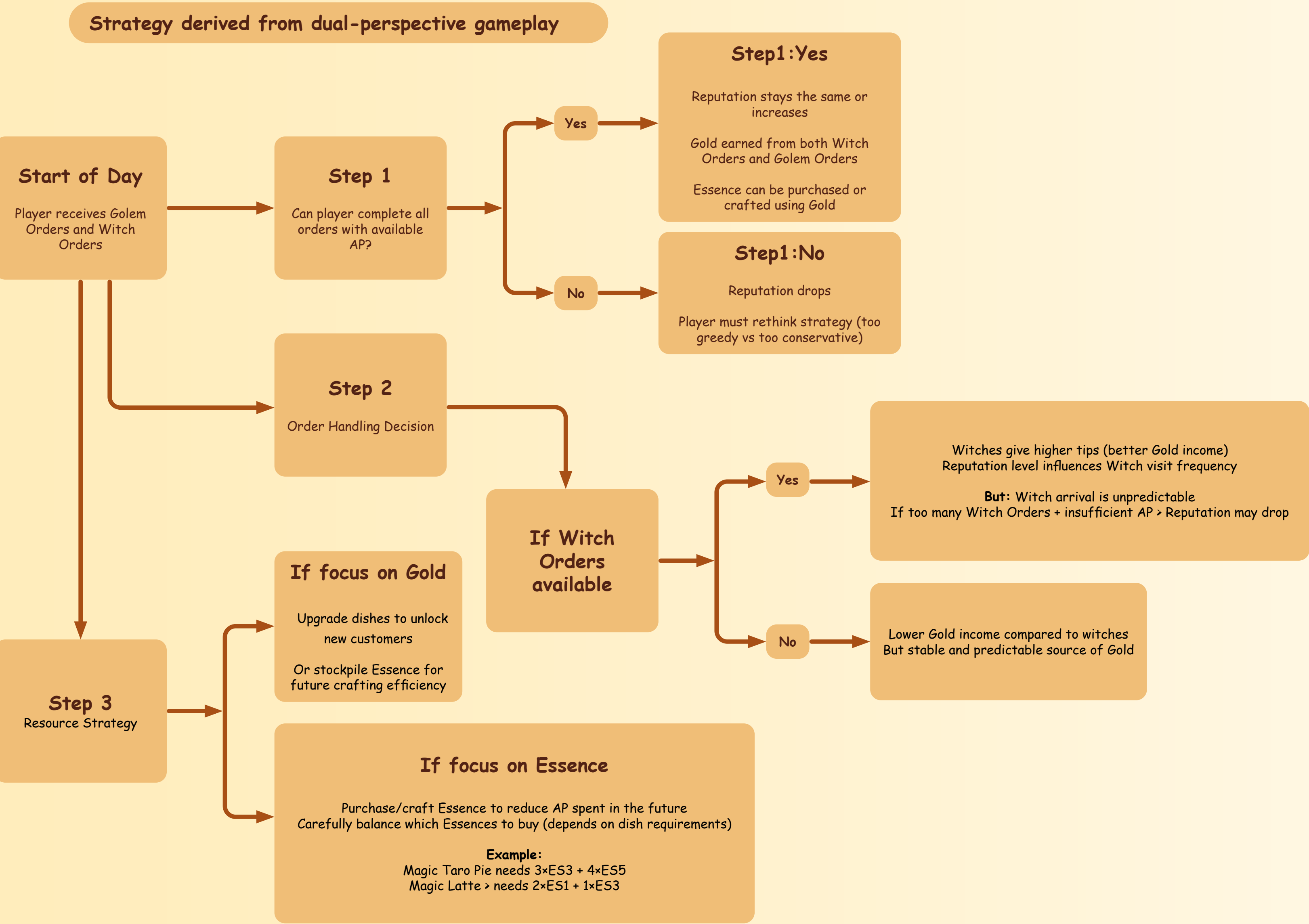
Be careful: if you didn't able to(not enough ap complete all of the golem orders and witch orders by the day, your Rep will drop. This will make the player to balance between greedy strategy(accepting more orders to earn more money and save AP) and more conservative strategies. Players must balance these resources and Action Point, as Gold is earned from serving witches and completing golem delivery orders while Essence is used to unlock different cuisines and upgrade offerings.

Be aware, although it is a linear design that Essence can be crafted by gold. Certain kind of dishes require certain kind of Essence combined to be crafted. Let's say there's a magic taro pie requires 3x es3 and 4x es5, and there's a magic latte requires 2xes1 and 1x es3. With this combinations of dish-essence, player need to carefully consider when purchasing Ess, how to buy in order to serve more orders, and how to buy in order to minimize the number of perspective switches to reduce action point consumption. When making money, should they first upgrade dishes to unlock new customers, or should they first stockpile a large amount of Ess to save purchase time (AP) in the future?

Situation >> busy day
This is a safe situation with enough Essence and 7 orders and 1 witch order(8 orders in total). If this player switch the view to Anne and accept more orders and back(-3 AP in total and 1 order increase),this will turn to a tricky issue. The player will have no other AP left to cope with another witch's arrival



Gameplay & Mechanics



Greedy Strategy (take more orders)

Pros: More Gold in short-term

Cons: Higher AP cost may fail orders Reputation loss

Conservative Strategy (fewer orders)

Pros: Easier to manage AP, stable Rep

Cons: Less Gold growth, slower upgrades





Controlling Jessica, player press E to interact with the bar, kitchen, Anne and customers.



Controlling Anne, player controls a static scene and panel to do the owner's job---
--tactics and strategy.



Jessica walk near the orb and press E to switch view to Anne. In Anne's view, click the button to come back.



We have Icons like Jessica's memo and Menu. This can make players know the details more

UX Principles:

Simplicity: The interface prioritizes easy navigation with a clean layout and minimal distractions. Only relevant information (e.g., resource counts, active tasks) is displayed at any given time.

Readability: Text is displayed in clear, legible fonts with contrasting backgrounds to ensure it's easy to read even in busy gameplay moments.

Responsive Design: The UI adapts to the switching of perspectives, with Anne's UI showing resource management tools and Jessica's UI focusing on orders and customer interactions.

Witch Portrait & Sprite



Recipe

It is really hard to remember all the orders..



UI / UX Design

Visual Style Iteration

Final Version



Old Version



Target Player

Player Demographics:

Age Range: 16-35 years old
Interests: Players interested in casual simulation games, resource management, and narrative-driven experiences.

Gaming Preferences: Ideal for players who enjoy games like Stardew Valley, Recettear, and Overcooked. The gameplay is easy to pick up,

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Game Accessibility:
The game is designed to be accessible to both casual players and those seeking a deeper, more strategic experience. The dual-character system offers variety, and the AP limit system creates pacing that encourages decision-making/management



AI Use of game balance design

In the early development stages, a Python-based version of this game was built to emulate the core gameplay loops and optimize the game's parameters. This simulation ran thousands of test scenarios to determine ideal AP cost structures, resource balance, and customer interaction probabilities.

AI Playtesting: The AI was used to "autoplay" the game, making decisions about which recipes to unlock, when to switch characters, and how to allocate resources. By running these simulations, the development team gathered valuable insights on game balance.

The use of AI allowed us to make data-driven decisions about the game's economy and mechanics, ensuring that the progression curve is challenging but fair for players. The AI simulations provided a foundation for future updates and expansions, allowing the design to evolve and scale.

With the help of this magical numerical designer, Players are more likely to get into the Flow while playing our game.

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